

A STEADY BONUS

Sleep Without the Spiral

A bedtime checklist for the nights your mind won't stop, built around the tools already inside Steady.

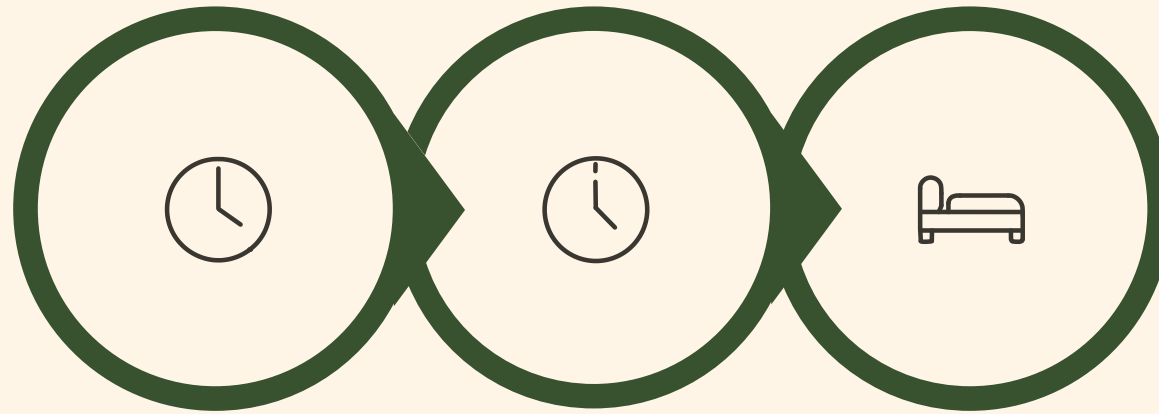
Why bedtime is when anxiety gets loud

During the day you're distracted — work, people, moving around. At night, the distractions disappear and your mind finally has room to run through everything it didn't get to. That's not a flaw in you. It's just quiet, for the first time all day, and anxious thoughts fill quiet space.

This checklist isn't about "trying harder" to sleep — trying harder is usually what keeps people awake. It's three short passes: two hours before bed, thirty minutes before, and once you're actually lying down. Tick what you can. Missing one doesn't undo the others.

How to use this

Print this page, or keep it open on your phone with Do Not Disturb on. Go down each section in order. If a step doesn't apply tonight, skip it — this is a menu, not a test.



Two Hours
Before

Thirty
Minutes

Lying Down

STEP ONE

Two hours before bed

□ Dim the lights

Even just the overhead light off, lamp on. Lower light tells your body it's time to start winding down.

□ Write tomorrow's to-do list on paper

Even three items. Getting it out of your head now means it can't ambush you at 11pm.

□ Open Steady's **Journal** and answer one prompt

Even two sentences. Anxious thoughts often just want to be written down once.

□ Set your phone to charge outside the bedroom

Or across the room — not within reach of the bed.

□ Caffeine check

Nothing caffeinated from here on.

STEP TWO

Thirty minutes before

- Do a full **Body Scan** in Steady (about 3 minutes)

Lying down is fine, it's built for this.

- Turn on **Calm pad** or **Rain** from Steady's Sounds section

Let it run low in the background.

- Change into whatever actually feels comfortable

Not "sleep clothes," just comfortable.

- One glass of water, then bathroom

So you're not up again in twenty minutes.

Once you're lying down

□ Start **4-7-8 breathing** in Steady

Four in, seven hold, eight out.
Let voice guidance read it if that helps you keep your eyes closed.

□ If a thought pushes in, don't fight it

Just notice it, name it ("that's the work thought again"), and go back to counting your breath.

□ If you're still wide awake after what feels like 20+ minutes

Get up, sit somewhere dim, and do one round of **5-4-3-2-1 grounding** — then try again. Lying there getting frustrated teaches your brain that bed = struggle.

If your mind genuinely won't stop

That's a normal night, not a failure.

Skip back to the Journal one more time and do a brain dump — everything, unfiltered, no editing. You're not trying to solve anything at midnight, just get it out of the loop it's stuck in.

A note on caffeine, screens, and "sleep hygiene" advice

You've probably heard all of it already. This checklist skips repeating the standard sleep-hygiene list and focuses on the anxiety-specific part — quieting the racing mind, not just the room. If sleep is a struggle most nights, not just anxious ones, that's worth mentioning to a doctor.